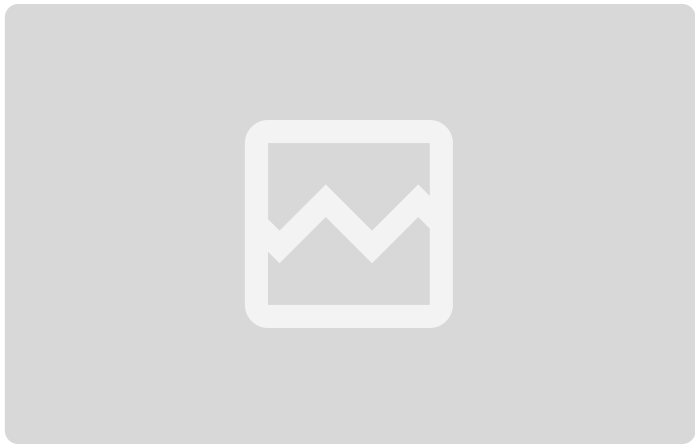




Exploratory User Research

Define the participant sample

Defining the participant sample means deciding who you need to talk to in order to understand the problem space and user context relevant to your project.

[Learn more in the UX/UI Hub](#)

Why does it matter in this phase?

In exploratory user research, the goal is not representativeness, but **diversity of perspectives**. A well-defined participant sample helps ensure that the collected data is **relevant, credible, and aligned with the research goals**, while preventing the collection of redundant or misleading insights.

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Step by step guidance

- ☐ **Define inclusion criteria**
Specify the characteristics participants must have to be relevant for the study (e.g. role, experience level, domain familiarity).

Students currently writing thesesStudents using existing university apps
- ☐ **Define exclusion criteria**
Clarify which profiles should not be included, to avoid bias or irrelevant perspectives.

University security staffProfessors
- ☐ **Decide approximate number of participants**
Determine a realistic number of participants based on time constraints, research goals, and the exploratory nature of the study.

Around 20 Interviews
- ☐ **Document rationale**
Briefly explain why this sample is appropriate for the project context and research questions.

Outputs to produce

⚙ Don't forget to upload them in the documentation section!

- ☐ **Participant profile description**
A concise description of the types of participants involved in the study.
- ☐ **Recruitment criteria**
A list of inclusion and exclusion criteria used to select participants.
- ☐ **Sample size justification**
A short explanation supporting the chosen number of participants.

Recommended tools



User Testing



Maze



Ethnio

Assignee



CG

Carlo Gutiérrez

Team Leader